



Acting4U

STAGE PLAYS FOR SCHOOLS

ALLEN GILLON



A fun play raising some of the problems
associated with inter-racial acceptance.

Grades 3 - 12

MELTING POT

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ABOUT THE AUTHOR: Born in Bowraville NSW, Allen Gillon qualified as a Teacher for the NSW Department Of Education in 1964, spending almost 25 years as a Primary Teacher. During that time Mr Gillon completed additional courses in musical arrangement at Sydney Conservatorium Of Music. He has written and had published a number of classroom texts, currently in use in Australian Schools. His musical training and experience resulted in his being granted many play and drama assignments, including a huge production of "Oliver" in the Penrith Department Region in 1977, co-ordinating 3 Primary schools, a 250 piece choir and a 13 member orchestra. Mr Gillon's love of writing and school performances led him to write and produce many plays. Public acceptance and the success of these plays led to the production of this publication.



OVERVIEW

MULTICULTURAL

This fun play raises some of the problems associated with inter-racial acceptance. Good overcomes bad, when the local Rescue Squad (made up of a number of Ethnic persons) is called in to rescue the two main characters. They are injured, hanging over a cliff, after stealing and crashing the new Chinese Judo instructor's car.

INVOLVEMENT

Safety equipment is required for Scenes 1 and 8, so I suggest you involve the local Rescue Squad or borrow from them such things as ropes, ladders, flashing lights, stretchers etc.

Scene 3 includes a Chinese Fable being read by Doctor Loo Chong. I suggest you involve Kindergarten children to perform as eight chimes of the Xylophone.

Scenes 7 and 9, The International Children's Concert, requires many national dances and songs. I suggest you involve some of the local ethnic groups (if appropriate), to assist the children in the concert.

SONGS

Scene 2 opens with Choir singing songs like "Everybody Loves Saturday Night!" in various languages. This may require local ethnic representatives to supervise choir's pronunciation.

Scene 4 requires Connie to solo a song about brotherly love. An appropriate song may be substituted according to local popularity.

LENGTH

This play is about two hours long. It may be shortened or lengthened in Scenes 7 and 9 by adding or subtracting "acts" for the "International Children's Concert".

MELTING POT

THE CHARACTERS

- | | |
|--------------|---|
| Curley | - an Australian man – good ‘bloke’ who loves his work |
| Jane | - an Australian Policewoman, concerned about the growing racist talk amongst the local children |
| Singh | - an Indian man - with black beard, turban and “goodness gracious” accent |
| Dolly | - an American adult girl with broad accent, lives in Australia |
| Dr Loo Chong | - a Chinese doctor, new in town, who has a black belt in Judo |
| Zulu | - a black South African man with a gravelly accent and good sense of humour |
| Besco | - local Australian boy with a racist attitude |
| Mallory | - local Australian boy who is Besco’s sidekick. |
| Marshall | - another boy, member of the gang |
| Missy | - local Australian girl, one of the gang |
| Mim | - tall girl with English accent |
| Tangles | - local Australian boy who stands up to Besco’s aggression |
| Tan | - Dr Loo Chong’s daughter, cries at the drop of a hat |
| Sandra | - Tan’s friend, comforts Tan when she cries |
| Burrinjuck | - an aboriginal boy |
| Connie | - Besco’s mother, Australian |
| Pam | - an Australian mother, friend of Connie |
| Beth | - an Aboriginal lady, mother of Burrinjuck |
| Shannon | - a mum, (any) accent |
| Julie | - Indian Lady with gem in forehead and national costume |
| Sharon | - Japanese friend of Connie |

MELTING POT

THE PLAY

- SCENE 1: Rescue Squad Training Centre
"How about a concert to raise funds?"
- SCENE 2: Pinball Alley
"Attitudes Exposed"
- SCENE 3: The Judo Club
"Dr Loo Chong's Encouragement"
- SCENE 4: At Besco's Home
"The Mothers Lend A Hand"
- SCENE 5: The Avenue
"Besco Can't Resist"
- SCENE 6: Speeding Along
"Pride Comes Before A..."

INTERVAL

- SCENE 7: International Childrens' Concert - Part 1
"Rescue Squad is called out!"
- SCENE 8: Rescue at Chinaman's Gap
"It's a long way down there!"
- SCENE 9: International Childrens' Concert - Part 2
"Love never fails!"

SONGS (Suggested)

Uno Paloma Blanca
Everybody Loves Saturday Night
(A Song of Brotherly Love)
What the World Needs Now
Love is a Beautiful Song
He's Got The Whole World in His Hands
Melting Pot - (Blue Mink)

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PERFORMANCE - your state branch of APRA (Australasian Performing Right Association) should be contacted prior to performance.

SCENE 1

P4

RESCUE SQUAD HEADQUARTERS

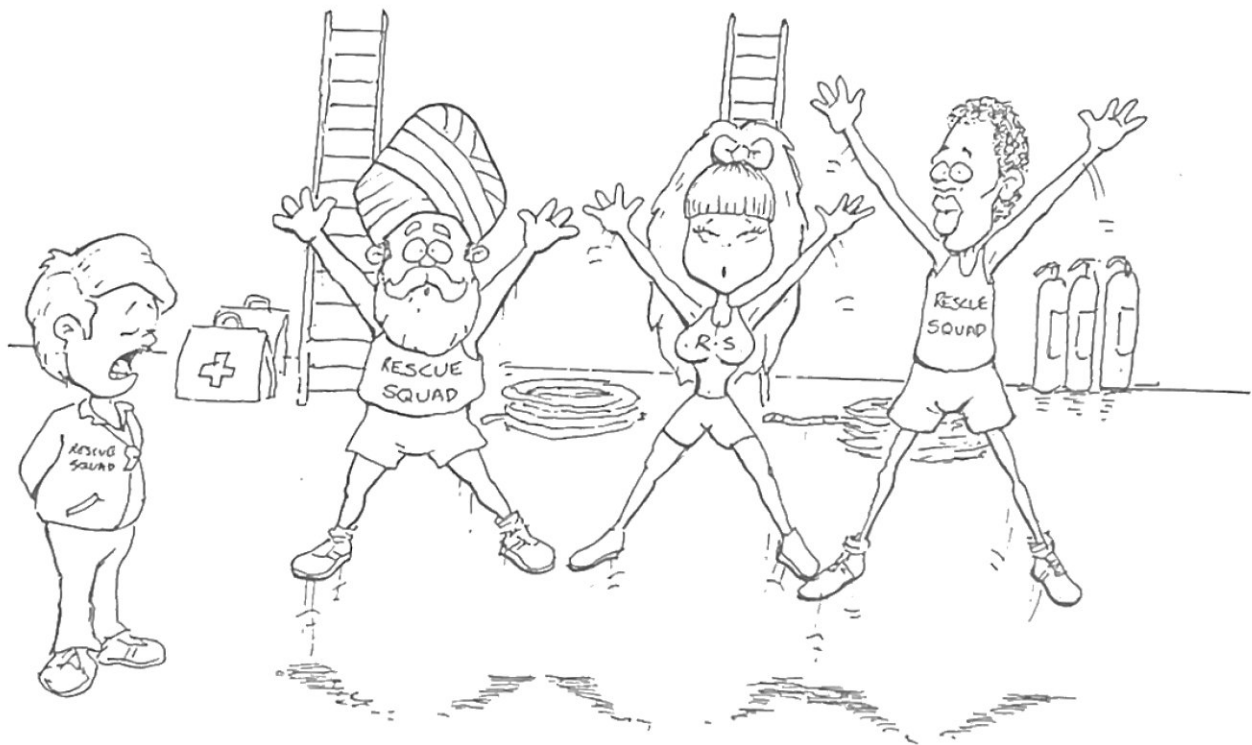
Stage set with equipment appropriate to RESCUE SQUAD training room, including ropes, fire-extinguisher, ladders, etc., spread across stage.

Members are at a TRAINING night meeting. They practice rescue procedures and do exercises. Members are wearing appropriate Rescue uniforms and hard hats.

Members include: (Accents preferred but optional)

CURLEY	-	Australian
JANE	-	Policewoman
SINGH	-	Indian
DOLLY	-	American
Dr LOO CHONG	-	Chinese
ZULU	-	South African
Extras	-	Non-speaking members of Rescue Squad

Curtains open on Curley (Rescue Squad Leader) directing warm-up exercises (star jumps). Singh, Dolly and Zulu are participating with other members of the squad. Jane and Dr Loo Chong are late, not yet on stage. As Scene 1 proceeds, the RESCUE SQUAD routinely goes through rescue procedures. All members should be involved; whilst script is proceeding extra members can be exercising with weights, rolling up long ropes etc.





Curley: (Doing star jumps in front of the squad - shouting) Hup Two! Hup Two! Hup Two! (Squad participates) Now, run on the spot! One Two! One Two! One Two! (till ready) OK! Touch your toes! Down Up! Down Up! Down Up!....Squad Halt!....stand at ease! (Squad obeys) Very good everyone! Now that we're warm, let's go through the different rescue procedures...(Squad moves to appropriate Rescue positions).

Dolly: (Picking up ropes and preparing for backwards "descent" across stage. Dolly has harness on - ropes tied around waist - ready to descend over edge of "cliff" - stage).
These ropes are really on their last legs, Curley! (Looking at frayed rope ends). Last time we used them, ah thought ah would end up like a mashed tomato at the bottom of the shaft.

Curley: (Picking up other end of rope) I know Dolly, but we've run out of money...they'll just have to last one more season.

(All join in assisting Dolly, "descend" across the stage, over edge, all holding end of rope).

Singh: Couldn't we have another fund raising day? We bought a fire-extinguisher (indicating) from the street stall money.

Curley: Yeh! That'd be OK, I suppose.

Zulu: Hey brother! We haven't been called out on many rescues lately. People might not respond very well to another money raising day.

Dolly: (Shouting from end of rope) Ah can't believe we have to beg for money Zulu...to rescue people.

(Enter Jane in Police uniform - proceeds to put overalls on and join in routine. Leave police hat on to reinforce character).

Curley: I agree Dolly, what we really need is something different to get the townspeople involved.

Jane: (joining in, holding rope) Sorry I'm late everyone...(still dressing). If you want to do something useful for this town, let's try and put a stop to the racism!

Singh: Racism!...in our town?

Jane: Yes Singh! That's why I'm late for training. I've just been down to that Pinball Alley...to break up a fight...only young kids, but they're calling each other "wogs", and "coons" and "chinks". Awful names! It's getting out of hand.

Dolly: Jane, it sounds like the States. We have some racial problems back there too. (picking up dummy victim, begins "ascent", others dragging on rope, pull both to top of "cliff").

Curley: Well, there are a lot of different nationalities in our town now - I supposed we have to expect trouble!

Singh: Goodness gracious! That's not true! It's usually just a few ringleaders...

Zulu: Hey..I think I know who that might be around here.

(Roll up ropes)

Jane: Well, I'm not mentioning any names...but we'd better do something soon.

Curley: That's two problems we've got. (holding frayed rope) We've got to stop ropes from fraying and we've got to stop tempers....

All: ...tempers from fraying!!

Dolly: It's not really frayed tempers that's the problem. It's lack of understanding and appreciation of others' talents.

Curley: Yeh! Just look at us. We're all different races. We work together. (indicating each) Dolly is American, Jane and I are Aussies. Singh is a Paki...(Singh cutting in)

Singh: Goodness watch it!

Curley: ...I mean Pakistani, Zulu is South African and Doctor Loo Chong is Chinese.

Jane: Not only different races but we have females too.

Singh: Yeh Yeh. Where is the Doc by the way? (holding up ladder for 'getting kitten out of tree" routine).

Curley: (about to ascend ladder) Zulu would you help Singh hold the ladder? Doc is still down at the Judo Club...looking things over. He takes over as instructor next week.. as soon as Jack leaves for Melbourne. (Climbs ladder).

Dolly: (enter Doc) Oh! Here's Doc now. (passing rope on long stick to Curley up the ladder) Hi! Doc.

- Doc: Do let me stop you everyone. I'll be ready in a moment (starts getting changed). Did I hear someone say something about being a racist?
- Curley: Yeh! Jane has had problems down at the Pinball Alley, with some kids picking on the new comers. (reaching up into "tree" - (lowers a furry "toy" cat - descends from ladder).
- Doc: Ah! That explains something (putting ladder away). Some of those boys were downright rude when Jack introduced me at the Judo Club.
- Jane: They'll change when you show them your Black Belt Doc.
- Doc: Oh! No! I'm not going to tell them I have a Black Belt in Judo, Jane. I want the kids to just accept me as their friend and instructor - no matter what colour I am!
- Jane: It won't be easy Doc. It's the same old problem...If you're new...you're not as good...if you happen to be a different colour...you're...
- Curley: (cuts in) Well look! Surely we can do something. What about involving the community to help us?
- Zulu: Maybe the community could help themselves at the same time (putting away equipment).
- Doc: What do you mean?
- Zulu: I mean if we got the kids...
- Curley: That's it Zulu! Get the kids involved with money raising for us. It'll give them a common interest.
- Singh: What, like a walkathon or concert or something? (begin checking fire-extinguisher)
- Doc: Better still! How about an international concert? With all the nationalities in our town involved.
- Jane: Yeh!...but it's the kids that are the causing the problems.
- Doc: Well...a CHILDREN'S concert...an International Festival ...we could start with the kids at the Judo Club...most of them would be in it, I'm sure!
- Jane: I'll talk to them if you like. Doc and I will be at the Judo Club tomorrow night (gives fire-extinguisher a trial).

Dolly: But, I think we should be involved too...in the concert I mean.

Zulu: All right! How about we put on a song? One that tells a story about all this racial bit!

Doc: Anything in mind Zulu..?

Zulu: No, brother! But I'll find us a song before our next meeting, OK?

Curley: OK! Well, that's about it for tonight Squad. Just check the petrol in the truck Dolly before you lock up and we'll meet here again next week.

(Curtains Lower Slowly)

Doc: How about (as they exit) a Beatles song, Zulu?

Zulu: Well... I dunno...maybe!

Doc: I've got a Chinese Dragon we can use...

Zulu: Ah! Good idea. We could all get under ... (keep conversation going until curtains close).



PINBALL ALLEY

Stage is set as a Café with pinball machines, electronic games, juke box, etc. Curtains closed. Choir - ready to sing - preferably standing at side of stage.

Before curtains open, Scene 2 begins with choir singing... songs like "Uno Paloma Blanca" and "Everybody Loves Saturday Night". Sing the verses in various languages, according to the local ethnic group influences. Suggest you get parental involvement to "teach" all Choir the verses.

As song finishes, a Chinese dragon begins weaving its way, noisily down the aisle, through audience. The juke box on stage begins to play (behind curtains). As dragon approaches stage, curtains open to reveal Pinball Alley. (Posters of pop-stars, Movie posters etc) The 'bad kids' are on stage playing machines, chewing gum, dancing etc. Main four are Besco, Mallory, Marshall and Missy. They are dressed as typical rebellious type kids. There may be others to fill stage.

Under the hessian (body of the dragon) are the "good kids" led by Tangles, Mim, Tan (Dr Loo Chong's child) and Sandra (others as needed). The kids under the hessian are doing a congo type dance in time with juke box. As they get to centre stage all gather around. Dragon does a circuit of the stage before dialogue begins.





Besco: (Chinese dragon weaves its way around Café)
(Runs over and switch off juke box - shouts) Hey! What are you doing...? Coming in here with that thing.

(Others shout "Get Lost"! etc. - begin to pull kids out from under hessian).

Missy: What are you doing? (shouts)

(Others from café join in the fun; get under hessian - shouting "It's great!" "Let's go!", "Who's under here..?" etc).

(One kid jumps on dragon's back. Besco tries to stop dragon...he jumps up on pinball machine...and...shouts ...)

Besco: (shouts) ST__O__P__P__P! ! (the dragon stops, gang gather with Besco, all begin to abandon dragon; a few hold head of dragon, noise fades to silence. Besco jumps down from machine and faces nose to nose with Tangles)

Besco: ...(continuing)... What do you think you're doing? ..bringing that thing in here...into our pad!

Mim: (coming to Tangle's aid) This is not your place Besco! We can come in here if we want to!

Tangles: Yeh! Besco!

Besco: (sarcastically) Yeh! What's this thing anyway? (pushing tangles away).

Mallory: Where'd you get this heap of garbage? (picking up hessian)

Mim: What's it (walking up to him) got to do with you Mallory?
(Those not in dialogue play pinball machines, get drinks, sit at tables)

Mallory: (pushing Mim aside) Listen Tangles, you brought it here.

Tangles: It happens to be a Chinese dragon.

Marshall: (sarcastically echo) A Chinese dragon! Looks like a heap of bags to me (picking up hessian).

Tangles: Don't be stupid Marshall, this isn't the proper body for it! We just put this bag on it ourselves.

Besco: (grabbing him) Look Tangles, if you want to keep breathing, you'll tell us where you got it.

Tangles: It belongs to the new Judo instructor, Dr Loo Chong.

Besco: Ah! That "chink". I saw him at the Judo Club last night.

Tan: (Shouts, breaking into tears) Don't call my father names!

Besco: Who are you, creep?

Tan: (gradually crying) Dr Loo Chong is my Daddy. You shouldn't say things like that about him.

Sandra: (comforting Tan) Oh! Don't let him worry you Tan (to Besco) He's just a racist!

Besco: Huh! There's already too many wogs around here, without (pointing to Tan) bringing more Chinese in, heh! Gang!.

(All gang shout Yeh! That's right, etc)

Marshall: (shouts laughingly) What would a doctor know about Judo anyway?

Tan: (crying still) I'll bet he knows more than you.

Besco: Huh! (sarcasm)

(let Tan cry for a while)

Mim: ...and Tam's dad is in the rescue squad too; they didn't care if he is Chinese.

Besco: Yeh! Well who needs The Rescue Squad?

Mim: You could need them one day Besco.

Besco: Yeh! Well if I need rescuing I won't be calling that bunch of know-alls.
(walks away)

Marshall: They're even got a Yankie girl that dangles over cliffs on a rope.

Tangles: Dolly happens to be an expert mountain climber.

Sandra: You're not only a racist Marshall, you're a sexist too.

Tan: (Loudly crying) I wanna go home.

Mallory: (To Tan) Listen stupid you're not going anywhere until you tell us what this is for. (indicating dragon).

Sandra: Leave her alone Mallory. This dragon is for the Chinese peoples New Year celebrations.

Tan: That's why Dad is having it mended...the tail got ripped.

Besco: Huh! (defiantly) They don't even know when New Year is! (gang laugh)

Marshall: Anyone knows it's the first of January.

Tangles: Not to the Chinese it ain't.

Besco: Well, they wouldn't know would they.

Tan: Our New Year is in February. Anyway, dad is getting the dragon ready for a festival.

Marshall: What are the Chinese doing having festivals in our country?

Besco: What are you doing in our country anyway?

Mim: Tan was born here!

Tan: ...and so was my mother.

Mallory: Well, you're still different.

Missy: Yeh! I'll say.

Tangles: (to Missy) You were born here, and you're certainly different (Tan, Sandra, Mim, other laugh).

Sandra: And my parents are from Germany aren't they. We're a different race altogether.

Besco: Well, at least you've got round eyes.

Missy: ...and white skin. (Mallory laughs)

Sandra: I reckon you kids are really rude.

Tangles: Just like you were to Dr Loo Chong at the Judo Club last night!

Besco: Ah! He ought to be sent back to where he came from (Tan begins to cry again)

Marshall: Yeh! Aussies were here first.

Tangles: Haw! You're dumber than I thought.

Mim: Anyone knows the aborigines were here first.

Besco: Hah! They don't count. Where'd they come from anyway?

Sandra: All races came from the same place.

Tan: Dad says that scientists can trace all the different races back to the same origin.

Besco: Haw! That'd mean we're all related.

Sandra: That's what it says in the Bible.

Tan: So all races do count!

Besco: I know what it says.

Tangles: (Pointing finger at Besco) You don't need us...you don't need the rescue squad...you don't need the Bible...what do you need Besco?

Besco: I need you to get out of here (pointing at dragon) with your ugly head and leave us alone.

Missy: Yeh! Marhsall - Yeh! Stupid.

Mallory: So get lost!

Tangles: Come on everyone. Don't worry about them. Let's have some more fun with the dragon...leave them alone!

Mallory: ...and watch yourself at Judo tonight too, Tangles.

Tangles: Huh! (Defiantly) We'll be there.

(All hop back under hessian (body of the dragon) and begin singing a song like "Leave me Alone". (Choir joins in). Dragon leaves stage dancing to the rhythm and departs down the aisle. As curtains closes, kids in the cafe return to pinball machines, etc. Besco switches juke box back on, defiantly gesturing at audience).

End of Scene.

SCENE 3

AT THE JUDO CLUB

In this scene are:

Doctor Loo Chong

Mr Singh

Constable Jane

Besco

Mallory

Tangles

Mim

Sandra

Tan

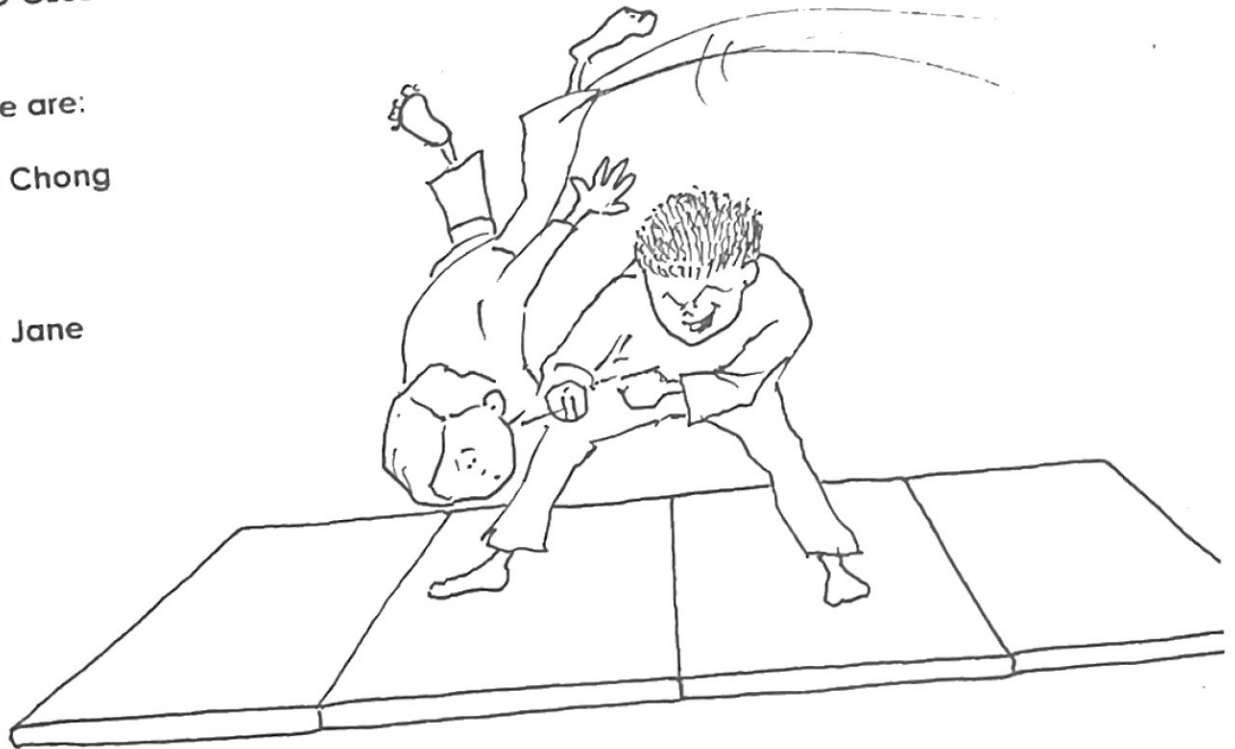
Burrinjuck (aboriginal boy)

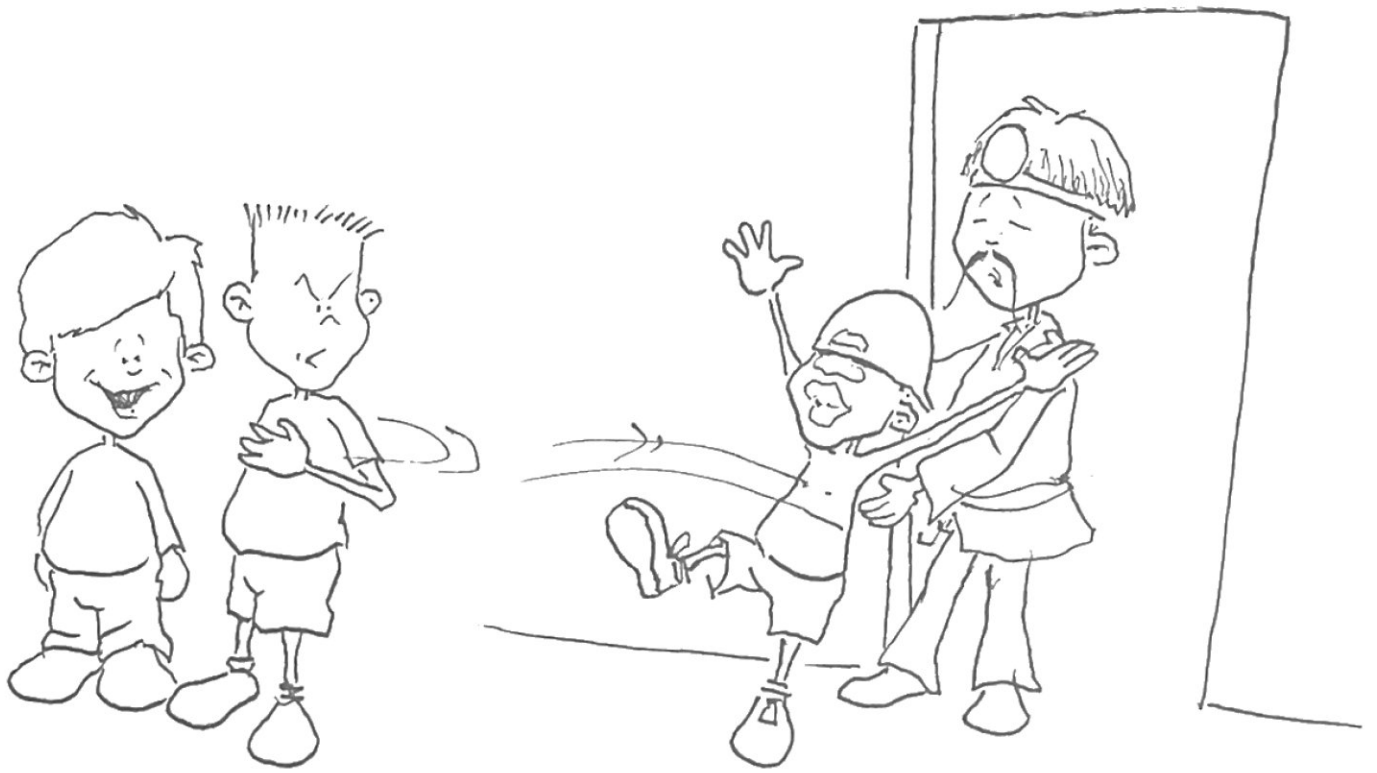
Others to help demonstrate Judo

Stage set with gym mats, wall signs advertising Judo Club 6.00 - 7.00pm - various pictures of Judo throws, etc on wall.

Curtains open on Besco and Mallory practicing "throws". A few others may be on stage, in background. All in Judo suits practicing throws and exercising.

(This Scene could be localised. Instead of Judo, Tai Kwon Do etc.)





Mallory: (Besco throws him onto mats...he sits up holding back of head). Ouch! Not so hard Besco. You'll crack my skull.

Besco: That's nothing to what I'll do to Tangles when he gets here...especially if he brings that Chinese kid.

Mallory: (as he gets up) Of course she'll be here...her father takes over tonight...as the new instructor ... you know, that Dr Loo Chung

Besco: Well, I reckon I might be quitting Judo after tonight.

Mallory: What will you do on Monday nights then?

Besco: I'll join some other club...one that's got all Ausies in it. (they perform another "throw")

Mallory: (as Burrinjuck walks in)....hey Besco, (sarcastically) Look who's here!!

Besco: Yeh! (pause) Hey, it's fun time again...Burrinjuck, do you wanna see the new throw we just learned?

Burrinjuck: What new throw?

Besco: Well, you grab one arm like this (Besco grabs Burrinjuck by the wrist with 2 hands and Mallory grabs the other wrist)...and Mallory grabs the other and you go 1, 2, 3 and away you go (they heave him backwards across the room towards the entrance, straight into the arms of Mr Singh and Dr Loo Chung as they enter.) Mim, Tan, Sandra and a few extras follow them onto stage.)

(All kids have Judo suits on).

(Burrinjuck yells as he hurtles across room)

Singh: (As Burrinjuck smashes into Mr Singh) Goodness gracious! What's happening here?

Burrinjuck: Oh! It's just Besco trying to be smart again! (he walks back to Besco defiantly but Besco and Mallory look innocently, as though it wasn't their fault).

Doc: Now boys, (ignoring what just happened) we start a brand new Judo programme tonight. Let's all sit down and let's talk about it. (They all sit. Besco and Mallory sit in background).

Singh: (motioning) Come on boys, move a little closer. (they do) (Introducing) This is your new Instructor Dr Loo Chung.

Doc: Your last instructor, honourable Mr Jack, whom you all loved very much...

Besco: (interrupting) Yeh! He was great....

Doc: ...he mentioned to me that some of you were having trouble accepting people from other cultures...like myself... and Dolly ... and Mr Singh here. Well that's not the way of Judo and certainly not the Australian way.

Singh: And Constable Jane said there was trouble down town last night too!

Besco: What's it got to do with you? (Singh looks astonished at this comment)

Doc: (walking over to Besco) Well, young man, it's got to do with everyone. (walking around stage) We are witnessing the movement of peoples from country to country now,...all over the world, more than any time in history.

Singh: And these people bring along with them many of their excellent customs...and skills!

Besco: Huh! (Defiantly waving it away)

Doc: ...like Judo. I learnt Judo from my honorable Japanese friend, Suzuki Kawasaki... he now lives in Wagga Wagga (all laugh).

Mallory: Well, why don't they stay in their own countries?

Doc: There are many reasons of course, young man...(indicating the rest of the kids seated) ... your friends can tell us some. Everyone, (asks a question) who can tell me some reasons why people have to leave their homelands and move to another country?

Tangles: (raising hand) Well, wars make refugees.

Doc: That is true.

Mim: ...and refugees have to move to other areas.

Tan: And some like my Daddy (she stands) just want a better place to work (she begins to cry again)...and he's a good Doctor too.

Sandra: Oh! Tan don't cry. (all laugh)

Tan: (crying on Sandra's shoulder) I can't help it.

Doc: (to audience in comical manner) My daughter is so emotional (putting arm around her) Never mind my darling. (walking to side of group).

Singh: (taking over) Now listen everyone, Dr Loo Chong has a very good idea, to help us.

Doc: (still with Tan)...and help the Rescue Squad raise some money too...

Besco: (standing) Hey! I thought we came here to do Judo.

Doc: Ah! Soh! We'll do some Judo too...in a moment ..(as he helps Besco to sit down again)... first I would like to tell you about a Concert we are going to put on. (All "Yeh!" "OK" Right on!" etc. some stand up.)... to help the Rescue Squad raise extra money for equipment. But before I do, I want to read to you, an old Chinese Fable. (they all sit down again) This is a very good story from China. I am sure we can all learn something from it. I have the story right here in my book of fables. Are you all ready?

(All nod and agree with "Yes!", "Sure!" "OK!" etc)

(Doc now reads Chinese Fable, see included on P42. Besco and Mallory give a few disapproving scoffs now and then, but they sit and listen). (Eight little Kindergarten children enter to "perform" as characters from the fable. They are dressed as little Chinese children with Chinese hats. They act out the fable on a separate part of the stage or right up front. As each little Chime is introduced, a Xylophone note sounds and that little character bows to the audience. Other comical incidents can be included to create the fun of the story. When Doc finishes reading the story to the group, all applaud, the Kindergarten children exit.) (Then as applause dies down ...)

Besco: Look! (stands up, shouting) If I want to hear fairy stories I'll watch Disneyland.

Mallory: What about some Judo? (stands)

Doc: Ah! Soh! We will now do Judo. Everyone line up. (they line up shoulder to shoulder; pushing by; Besco is ignored). We will start with break-falls...ready, on your face....fall!
(This becomes a Judo demonstration segment. One at a time performing break-falls) Now, on your side. (One at a time again). Now, partners for Uki-goshi. (Besco and Mallory stay together) Ready, step, side, throw...ah! Very good everyone. (Singh assists without getting too involved - he's a bit clumsy).

Besco: This is simple stuff.

Doc: (Ignoring Besco) Change partners for Tai Toshi (All change partners. Tangles grabs Mallory).

Mallory: Watch it! (Doc grabs Besco)

Doc: Now, we will have Tai Toshi. (Doc allows Besco to put him on mats backwards in a Tai Toshi throw. Besco shapes up very confidently).

Doc: Ah! Very good young man. (...As he gets to his feet).

Besco: Yeh! I know. (Doc grabs him).

Doc: Now it's my turn. Tai Toshi again everyone. (Doc throws Besco down. Besco gets a little upset....pushes Doc's hand away as he offers to help him up). How about Tomanargi now everyone?

Mim: But we haven't learnt that throw...that's too advanced for us.

Tangles: You have to be a black belt for that!

Doc: Ah! Soh! Then my daughter will help demonstrate it for you, with master Besco here.

Besco: Haw! She's no black belt...I'll bet you're not either...she's a pushover. Watch this Mallory (they grab each others jackets).

Tan: This is how you do Tomanagi ... You lay back, put your right foot up (etc, she grabs Besco and throws him over her head, hard onto the mat).(all applaud and laugh).

Besco: (jumps up...face to face with Tan) You won't get away with that chink...I wasn't ready...(Stomps towards exit) Come on Mallory, lets get out of here.

Tan: (begins to cry again) I didn't mean to hurt him. I was just showing him how to do it. (all laugh)

Burrinjuck: (comforting her) Don't worry Tan, (shouts) he's just a big bag of wind.

Besco: (stomping back into vision) Yeh! Burringjuck, just wait till you're out delivering your newspapers near my place again.

Mallory: Yeh! You'll get yours Burrinjuck. (the gang members stomp out noisily).

Missy: Yeh! (They exit pushing past Constable Jane as she enters)

Singh: Goodness gracious! Constable Jane was right. These children are growing into racists.
(Enter Jane in Police uniform, looking back at gang exiting).

Jane: Wow! What was that?

Doc: (to Singh) Ah! Soh! I agree, racists. I hope we can do something about it soon...

Jane : Hi! Doc, looks like Besco is up to his old tricks again! (Doc sadly nods). Can I have a word with the group tonight?

Doc: Of course, Jane. (to the group) Constable Jane has something to ask all of you ...please sit down again everyone. I'll just finish getting my Judo suit on!

Jane: (they sit in a bunch) Thanks Doc. (Doc leaves to change into his Judo suit with black belt) At the training session last night, Doc made an excellent suggestion to help raise funds for the Rescue squad.

Singh: and...and.... (prompting Jane)

Jane: Oh! Yes, thank you Singh, and most of all, to get all of our ethnic groups together for some fun...(All Oh Yeh! Ooh! Aah! Excitedly)
...I want to compliment all of you first, for your acceptance of Dr Loo Chong as your new Instructor, he's doing this free of charge you know, to help all of us! ... and Mr Singh too...but unfortunately some of you may be influenced by others in our community, who express their feelings against our new friends. So how would you like to be involved in ... (louder)an International Children's Concert? (all Yeh! Great! Etc)

Tangles: What do we have to do? (Doc enters still putting on his suit).

Doc: Well everyone, we thought that we could display some of our cultural backgrounds ... through songs and dance...including the Aussies of course.

Jane: That way we could kill two birds with the one stone! We could raise money for the rescue Squad... and at the same time create unity through fun, song and dancing. Would anyone like to be involved?

All : Yeh! Great! etc

Singh: Can any of you sing or do a dance?

Burrinjuck: I can get some friends and we could do a corroboree.

Doc: Ah! Soh! (nodding) That would be great!

Sandra: ...and I can sing a German Beer song. (all laugh)

Doc: That's it. So let's all get our friends together and be ready for the (in an announcing voice) International Children's Concert (all applaud and cheer)....well now, are we ready for some more training? (all Yeh! etc)

Mim: Can you teach us the Tomanargi throw Doc? (all stand and grab partner but stand, poised ready to be shown how).

Doc: Oh! It's easy. Tan, would you demonstrate with Mr Singh this time.

(Mr Singh looks shocked and begins to back off saying No! No! But Tan grabs him and executes a perfect throw landing Singh sprawling on the stage).

(All laugh and join in with a partner. Singh takes it all in good fun. He pretends to limp about holding his back. Constable Jane joins in too. Lots of noise and action. As curtains close...)

Tangles: (shouts) I didn't realise you were a black belt Doc...do you mind if we call you Doc?

Doc: Oh! No! Most certainly you may. Now Ushi-Goshi everyone.

(CURTAINS close as all are performing throws.)

SCENE 4

BESCO'S HOME

P21

Curtains open on a KITCHEN SCENE. Mrs Connie Exide (Besco's mum) enters with a bag of shopping. She switches on the radio which plays music, small news item and then main theme song, (A Song of Brotherly Love), as she unpacks the shopping. Connie hums audibly along with the music - she's happy.



Connie: (Goes over to turn down radio...shouts) Are you home Besco? (no reply, more music plays, more humming)(Turns down radio again) (loudly) B-e-sco! (no reply)

(She pours herself a drink from a jug on the table, sips, puts apron on, leans against table facing audience, deep in thought, switches off music. Calls out again) Besco! (no reply)

(Soliloquy begins - sadly) Besco's always out lately...and he's getting so cheeky...I don't know what I'm going to do with him. (put drink down and put saucepan away. Pick up drink and sit at table - worried)

The girls will be here soon, and he hasn't done his room...It's not as though I haven't tried (stand) I talk to him; I show love to him... (put tray of glasses on table, sit) Ever since Dan went missing in East Timor

.. (or more appropriate situation according to recent news)... he's become uncontrollable....he's beginning to show hate rather than love (stand, put radio on again - theme song plays. Connie sings solo, choir joins in - optional. Connie sits as song ends, head bowed).

(loud knock on door)

Connie: Come in girls! (Stays seated)

(Enter Pam, Beth, Shannon, Julie, Sharon)

Pam: Hello Connie....been shopping? (all make themselves comfortable. Beth begins to pour drinks and hand them around).

Connie: (blankly) Yes, Pam...just got home. Thanks for coming over girls....you all look so...(lowers head)..happy!

Beth: You seem a little down hearted Connie...what's the matter?

Connie: Oh! I was happy when I came home Beth...but Besco isn't here again...I'm afraid I'm losing him.

Shannon: I saw him down at that Pinball Alley as I drove past.

Julie: Yes, he's there a lot, isn't he Sharon...with that Marshall girl.

Shannon: and....Brett Mallory.

Connie: I don't know what to do! (take apron off)

Beth: Look, Connie, all around the world it's getting the same...no love thy neighbour anymore! The kids are being influenced by all sorts of nasties.

Connie:but Dan and I raised Besco with all the love we could.

Beth: It just shows you what can be undone ... especially when they get around as a gang!

Julie: Yes, he wasn't always like this...until he started hanging around with that other bunch.

Connie: (stand) Anyway that's just another one of my problems...I don't want to burden all of you with it.

Julie: We'll help if we can Connie...

Connie: Thanks Julie, I know you would. Look, let's get down to business...I asked all of you to come over today for a special reason. You all know the new doctor, Dr Loo Chong, don't you? (all Yes! Etc)

Beth: Oh! He's the new instructor at the Judo Club too, isn't he?

Connie: Yes, Beth...he's been training with the rescue squad too, but they need more money for equipment...so he's organising an International Children's Concert ... and he asked me if I might get an act together ... for the concert.

Sharon: An International Children's Concert! I wondered why you called us...(looking around) ... most of us have ethnic or international background.

Connie: That's right Sharon.... I thought, for the concert...we mothers might help by putting on a song, together...I was thinking about a medley of songs ... about love for people?

Pam: Ooh! I'd love to be in that! (excitedly)

Beth: Me too...do we sing altogether?

Sharon: ...what about "Love is a Beautiful Song!"

Pam: ... and "All you need is Love"

(Other appropriate songs may be chosen here).

- Connie: Yeh! That's great!...will you all be in it then? (all yes! OK! Etc)
With your ethnic background we could make it even more colourful by dressing up...especially you Sharon...seeing your Dad was Japanese ... and Julie, have you got a sarong you can wear?
- Julie: Yes, it's in the cupboard somewhere.
- Pam: Where's the concert going to be held?
- Connie: Doc said he'd let me know.
- Sharon: How come adults are in a children's concert?
- Connie: Well, who do children learn from?
- Pam: Parents?
- Connie: Right.
- Sharon: Yes, I suppose that's right, we should take the lead...more than we do...
- Pam: Set the example for them.
- Shannon: It might help the kids see the good in different races.
- Connie: (sadly) I hope it will help Besco.
- Shannon: I'm sure it will Connie.
- Connie: (changing the mood) Well, let's get started on our act, heh!
- Pam: How about we break into pairs and sing a song together?
- Connie: (smiling) OK Pam, you and I...ready (sing) "What the World needs now, is love sweet love..."
(Besco stomps in holding one shoe in his hand, wearing the other)
- Besco: (shouting) Hey Mum! Have you seen my sneakers anywhere? ... (he stops suddenly when he sees the girls) (he looks at one in particular).
(Looks at audience) Ah! No! not more of 'em.
- Connie: Where have you been dear?
- Besco: Ah! Nowhere...I need my sneakers...we're going for a burn on our bikes.

Connie: Would you do your room before you go dear?

Besco: Oh! Come off it...the gangs outside, waiting for me...I'll do it later (he stomps out of Kitchen).

Connie: (following him) Besco! Besco come here! (coming back with tears) He just won't obey me!

Pam: (comforting her) We know how you feel Connie. (all gather around)

Sharon: Come on, we'll make you a cup of tea...sit down here, we'll look after you. (Pam goes to the sink, Sharon gets cups and saucers)

Beth: When you feel better, we'll go through the songs, OK?

Connie: (recovering) Oh! I'm all right, I suppose. (regains composure, stand and holds hands up to conduct) Let's do it again...altogether this time (sing) "What the world needs now is love..."

CURTAINS CLOSE SLOWLY – CHOIR TAKES OVER AND FINISHES SONG AFTER CURTAINS CLOSE.

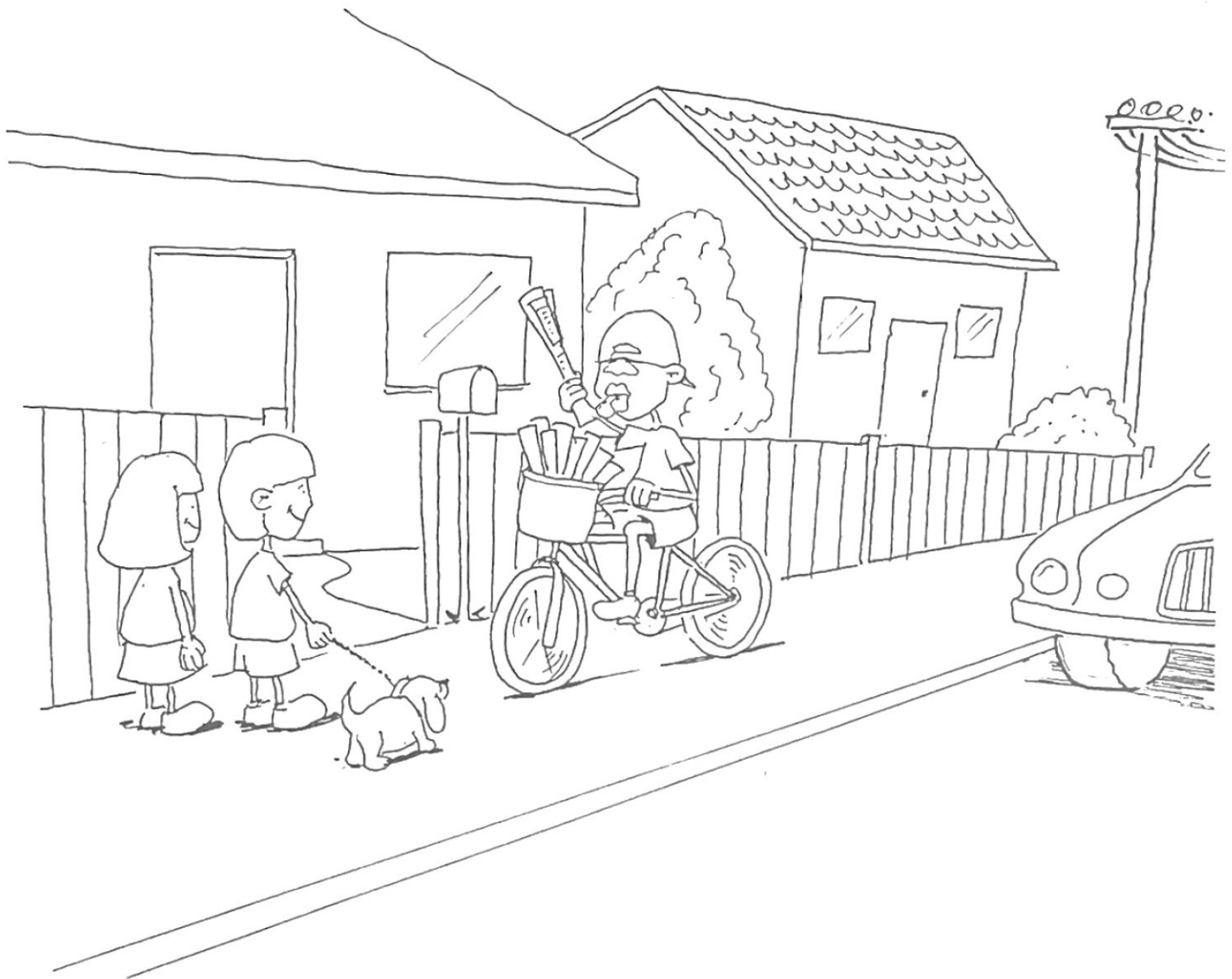


DARKENED STREET SCENE

Burrinjuck is delivering papers on his bike, LATE IN THE EVENING. He is met in the street by Tan and Sandra walking their dog. A full size, cut-out of a car, facing front-on, is "parked" rear of street scene (to be used as a stolen car in Scene 6).

Burrinjuck blows his whistle, comically throws a paper or two into the audience, puts another in a mailbox ... rides his bike over to another mailbox near where Tan and Sandra are about to enter.

(Enter Tan and Sandra and dog - optional - on leash.)



Burrinjuck: (shouts before they get near) Hey you fellas, what are you doing?

Sandra: (ENTERS) Hi! Burrinjuck...can we have a newspaper?

Burrinjuck: No fear! These have their names on them. Where are you fellas going anyway?

Tan: Dad asked us to collect the tail of our dragon...

Burrinjuck: Oh!

Tan: ...so it'll be ready for the concert tomorrow.

Sandra: Do you want to come with us?

Burrinjuck: Nah! I've got to get these papers delivered.

Sandra: Well, we'll help you. Who are these? (takes a paper from the bike)

Burrinjuck: There's Mr Singh (picks up a few papers), Jack McGregor...Oh! He's gone to Melbourne ...(puts it back in the bag).

Sandra: I've got one for Jane!

Tan: Jane who?

Sandra: Our local Copp...er! ... I mean Constable ... ess.

Tan: (looking at paper) Who's this?...a Mrs Exide

Burrinjuck: That's Besco's mum.

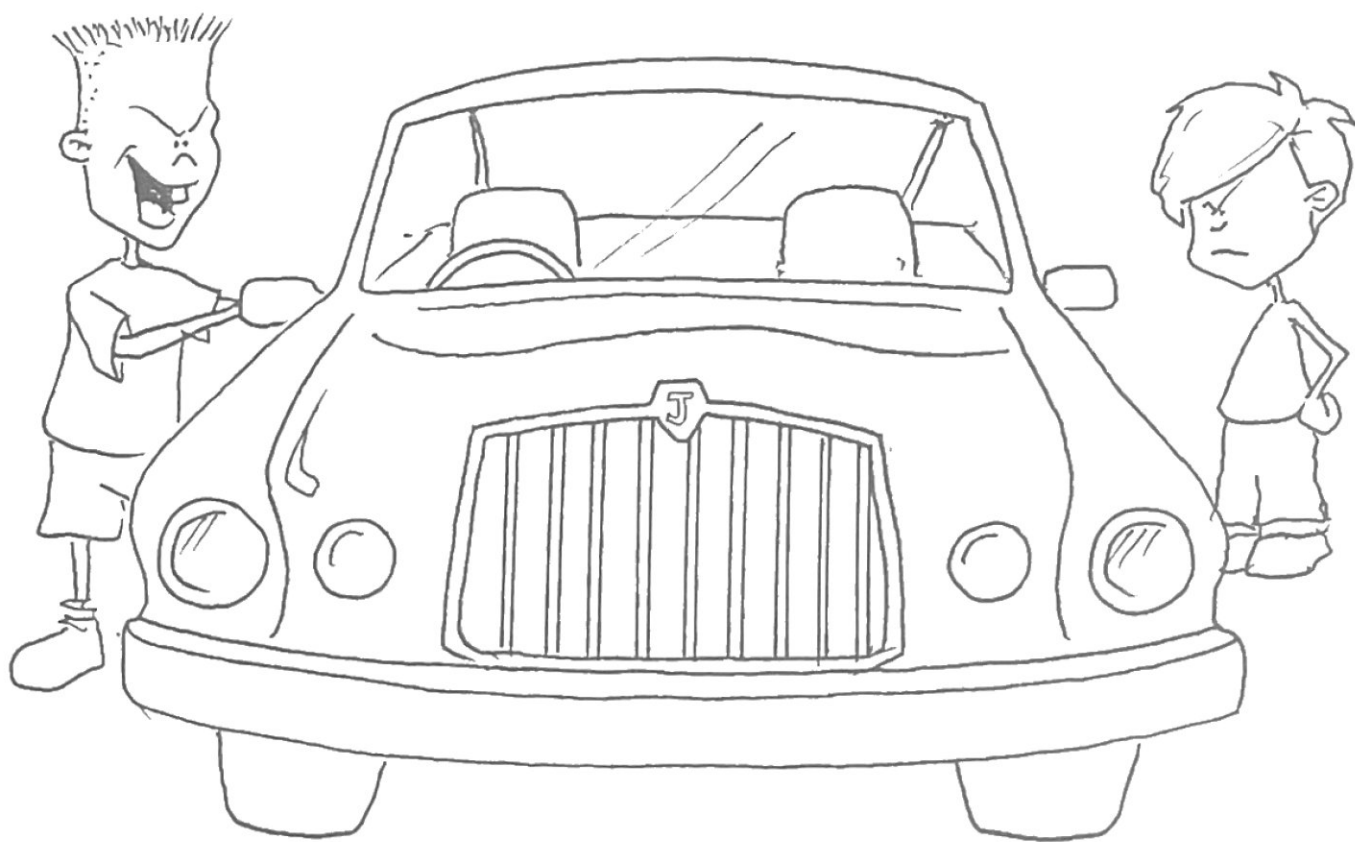
Tan: Oh! That racist boy! Does he live around here? (grabs Sandra in fright)

Burrinjuck: Yes! He lives just up there (pointing) Oh!..Oh!...(shouts) Here he comes on his bike ... (Tan begins to cry) See you later girls! (Burrinjuck rides off stage). I'm gettin' out of here!

Sandra: (following) We're coming too!

(As they exist Besco speeds onto stage on his bike, does a slide with back wheel, halts)

Besco: (Shouts) Look at 'em go!
(Mallory, Marshall, Missy come running or if room permits, riding onto stage).



Mallory: Yeh! (laughingly) Did you see Burrinjuck run?

(Missy goes over to examine car on the street backstage, Marshall takes newspaper from letterbox).

Besco: (shouting after them) Hey chink! Where'd you park your broom?

Marshall: Hah! Hah! (throws newspaper towards exit) A Chinese witch!

Besco: He must be visiting that nig-nog up there. (slaps Mallory's open palm) Zulu, what a name...(sarcastically) give me five brother!

Mallory: Hey! That's a new club we can join...(laughingly).

Mallory/Besco: Yeh! ...the Klu Klux Klan (all laugh)

(Besco gets off his bike, walks over to car, peers inside).

Mallory: (imitating Zulu's voice). Oh! You is a bad boy! (Marshall hops on Besco's bike).

Besco: You know what?

Mallory: What?

Besco: This is an automatic!

Mallory: No kidding!

Besco: You know what else? (opens car door)

Mallory: (mischievously) It's got keys in it.

Missy: (frightened) Besco! No! Don't!

Marshall: I'm getting out of here. (to Missy) Hop on, quick. (Missy hops on bike - they exit).

Mallory: (shouts after them) Ah! You chickens.

Besco: (leaning out car window) Let's take it out to Chinaman's Gap.

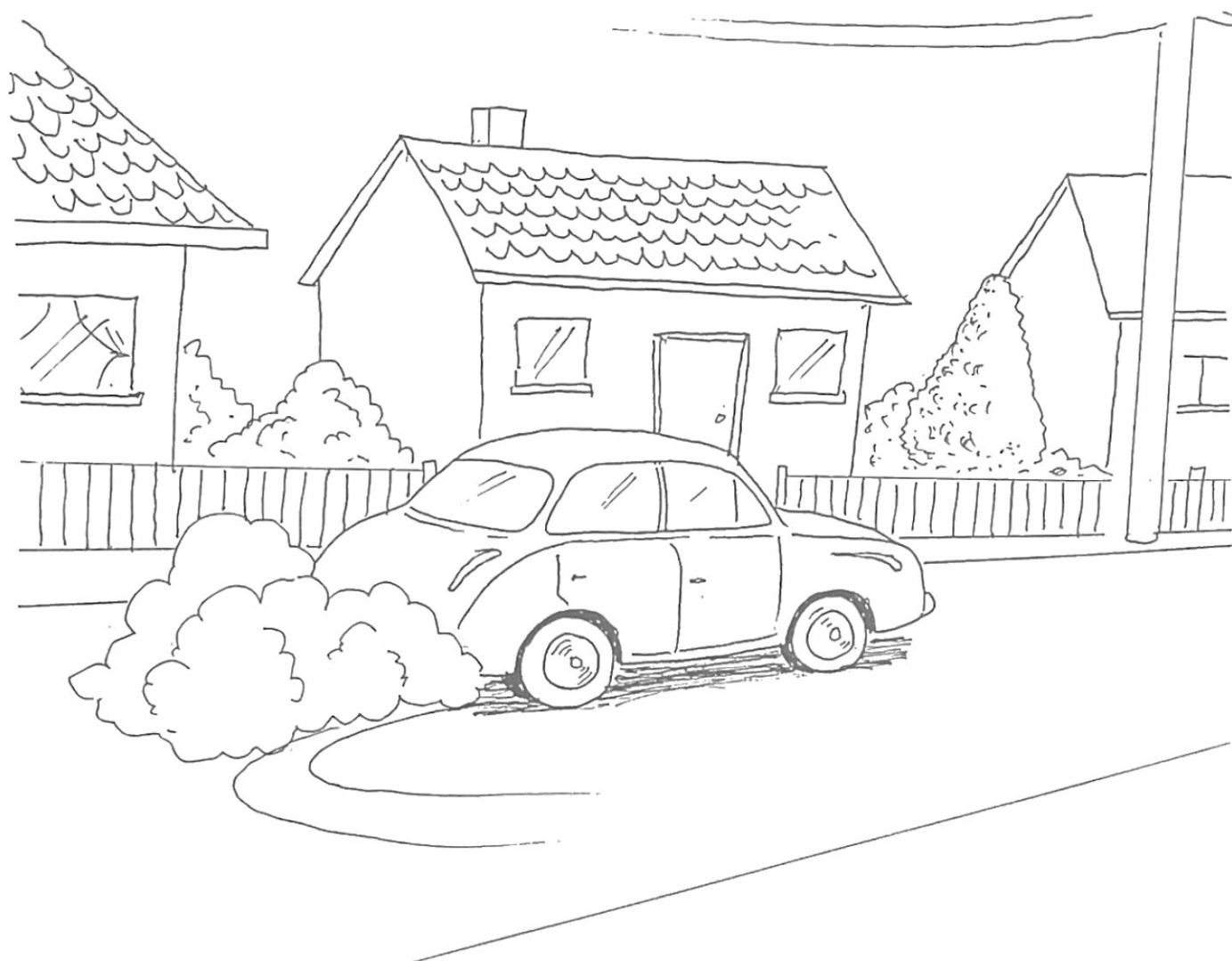
Mallory: Yeh! It's a Chinaman's car (laugh).

Besco: Get in Mallory, before that Chinaman gets back.

Mallory: (walking to back of car) I hope you can drive this thing.

Besco: Course I can!

(Curtains close as recorded car engine starts and speeds off).



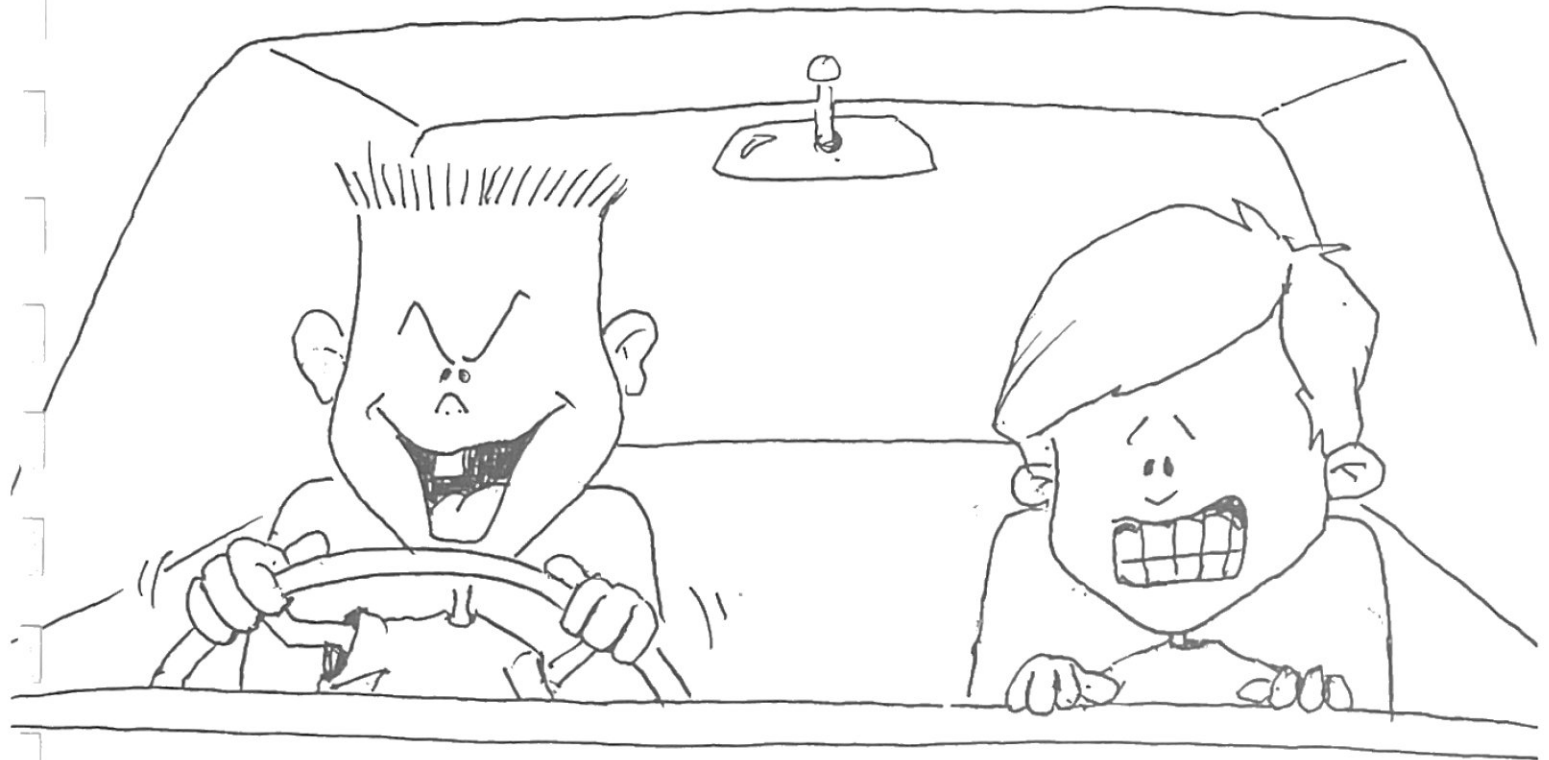
SPEEDING ALONG

Curtains Closed – house light down.

Spot light comes on to reveal Besco and Mallory, in front of curtains, face on to audience, driving along in a car.

Besco is driving. Mallory is in passenger seat obviously scared.

Suggest you use a 2 dimensional cut-out of a car front on. Besco and Mallory are looking through - no windscreen. Recorded car noise increases, continuing from Scene 5 - fades to allow dialogue to be heard.



(Recorded noise of car engine can be heard during dialogue)

Besco: Hey, this thing can really go! How fast are we driving now?

Mallory: (obviously scared) A hundred and f-f-forty! (shaking in his seat, gripping tightly)

Besco: What's the matter Mallory? Scared of a bit of fun.

SOUND UP

Mallory: N-N-Nah! Of course not. (shouts) Watch out for the footpath! (they tilt as though travelling on 2 wheels) (Tyres screech) (Scream) A-a-a-h!

Besco: Yahoo! Ride 'em cowboy. (Car comes back to 4 wheels)
(car noise volume down)

Mallory: (looking sideways, pointing out through the missing front windscreen) There's a truck coming! A-a-a-h!

SOUND ON (He ducks out of view. Loud truck horn sounds. Car noise volume up then fade).

Besco: Hah! He missed us...you can come up now Mallory.

(Mallory, one hand at a time, then nose and eyes, appears in windscreen)

Besco: This is great, heh!

Mallory: Yeh! (half smiling) G-g-g-great! Listen, Besco, don't you think we'd better go back now?

Besco: Nah! We're nearly there. Wait till that Chinaman finds his car at the bottom of the Gap.

Mallory: Yeh! (shakey) Maybe us too!

Besco: Don't be stupid, we'll jump, just before it hits the safety fence.

Mallory: OK, but not so fast or they'll have to send that Chinese quack down to put us back together again.

Besco: Huh! (sarcastically) He wouldn't come near me...or that Zulu...or Singh...who needs 'em anyway?

Mallory: (pointing out the windscreen) There's the safety fence. Just around this next bend is Chinaman's Gap.

Besco: OK! (imitating a pilot) Fasten your seatbelts ladies and jellybeans, this car is about to take off. Ready to jump Mallory? Here we go! (they lean our car "door")

SOUND UP

Loud sound of car crashing and screams as boys try to jump from car. Stage blackens as they obviously go over the "cliff" (stage front) with the car.



INTERNATIONAL CHILDRENS' CONCERT

Stage is set as an outdoor concert. Lots of people in National costumes. Flags, banners, balloons etc.

Some are sitting, some are standing ready to perform their act.

Doc Loo Chong is on a pedestal to the side – he is MC for the concert.

Before curtains open, Choir performs a medley of international songs (select according to local community) – curtains open as choir concludes medley. Lots of cheering and applause by performers as curtains open.

(Small riser on stage on which "acts" can perform and be seen.)

Doc: (Raising arms to quell the noise) Thank you, thank you everyone. On behalf of the Rescue Squad, I would like to thank you all for coming and supporting our money raising concert. Is everybody happy? (all applaud, etc) We're here today to help raise money for our wonderful Rescue Squad. We are all appreciative of the volunteer work they do – and who knows when you may need their help and expertise! Now let's get on with the festival of international brotherhood. Our first act is "The Boleros", youngsters all the way from Spain (or an act that is appropriate to local community). Make them welcome to our (announcers voice) International Children's Concert!

(Concert continues)

Doc continues to introduce a variety of international acts who wholeheartedly perform for the audience. The number of acts can be decided upon according to time limits for the play.

Doc: (Continuing to introduce the performing "acts") And now, the one we have all been waiting for . Please give a big warm welcome to the "International Mothers Club". (All applaud as mums move to perform their song.)
(As "Mothers" begin the second verse of "What the World Needs Now", Missy and Marshall come running onto the stage. They shout across to Constable Jane and Curley. Song stops).

Missy: (excitedly) Listen everybody. Listen! There's been an accident.
Besco stole a car...

Marshall:and it crashed...

(Mrs Exide puts hands over face)

Missy: It's over the cliff. They got caught in it.

Marshall: ...at Chinaman's Gap.

Jane: Hold on Missy...where did you say?

Marshall: ...at Chinaman's Gap, it's over the cliff.

(Mrs Exide is comforted by others)

Curley: Sounds like a job for the Rescue Squad, Jane.

Jane: 10-4 Curley. Mrs Exide, would you like to come with us..?

Zulu: I'll get the truck Curley.

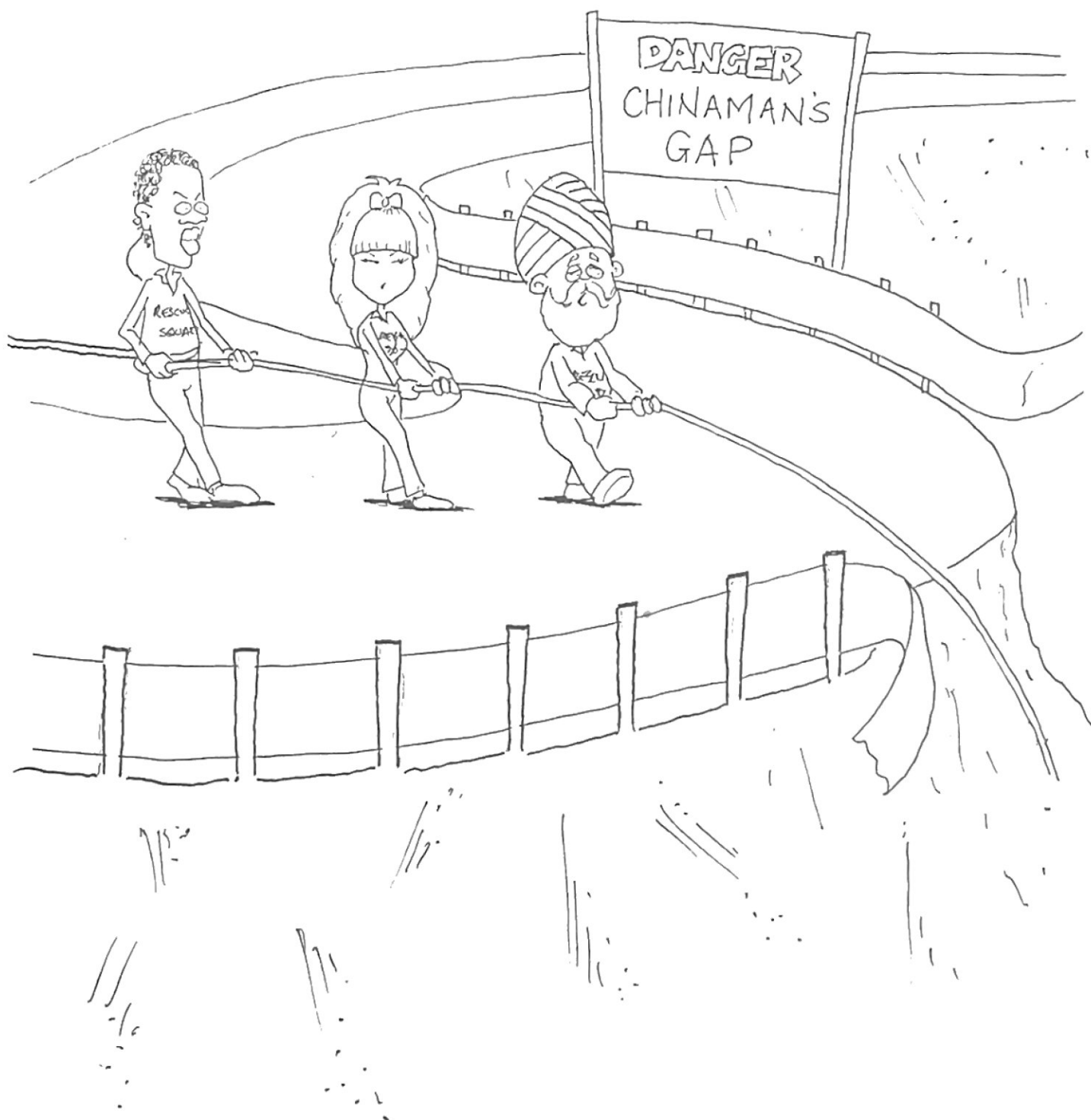
Curley: Right Zulu....sorry to break up the concert everyone....but we'll be back as soon as we can.

(They all applaud as Rescue Squad rushes off).

CURTAINS

THE RESCUE

Curtains open to reveal a steep cliff – if possible leading down to the feet of the audience. Signs showing DANGER, CHINAMAN'S GAP. Broken guard rail hanging over cliff. Rescue Squad already on cliff-top, setting up gear, ropes, flashing red light, etc. Stage lights come on to reveal Besco lying motionless at audience's feet. Car is there too smashed up. Mallory is half-way down cliff, injured, moaning.



Curley: (peering over edge of cliff) There's one of them....way down there...can't tell how bad he's hurt though....you'll have to go down Dolly.

Dolly: I'll get ready Curley. (She can be seen strapping rope around waist...testing its strength , etc.)

Curley: Got your first-aid kit Doc?

Doc: We're setting up a spine-board Curley. (Doc and Singh can be seen putting ropes on spine-board).

Curley: Need anything else...?

(Zulu and Curley assist Dolly over the edge - she begins backward descent down towards audience).

Dolly: How about some wings Curley? It's a long way down there.

Curley: (laughingly) I'll see if there's any wings in the truck, Dolly.

Dolly: More rope. (she descends till level with Mallory) Where does it hurt young fella?

Mallory: My arm, I think it's broken....and my leg too.

Dolly: This one's got a broken arm Doc...you'll have to come down.

Doc: Ah! Soh! (to Singh) I was hoping she wouldn't say that. (Zulu begins strapping rope around him).

Zulu: OK Brother, here you go!

Doc: Pass my first-aid kit Singh.

Singh: Here you are. (they assist him over the edge).

Doc: Now I know how a yo-yo feels. (Doc tentatively descends until he reaches Dolly comforting Mallory).

Dolly: Good on you Doc!

Doc: Now let me have a look (He holds up Mallory's leg). Ah! Soh! Just a sprain...not broken. (He examines his arm).

Dolly: This arm doesn't look good, Doc.

Mallory:ah! My arm!

Doc: Ah! Soh! We'll need a splint on this, it's broken all right. (Doc proceeds to put a splint on Mallory's arm).

Dolly: You take care of him Doc. I'll head down to young Besco. (shouts to the top) More rope! (Dolly proceeds to descend)

Doc: This should help young man.

Mallory: Ah!...my arm! Ah!...my leg! (Doc looks down the cliff)

Doc: (Echoing Mallory's lines in a comical fashion) Ah!...my car! It's all smashed up.

Mallory: It was Besco, he made me. We got caught as it went over.

Doc: You're both very lucky you didn't go all the way down with the car. It's way down there.

Curley: (interrupting Doc) How are you doing? Need anything else? We're coming up! (Doc and Mallory ascend).

Dolly: He's unconscious. I'll need some help.

Zulu: I'll bring a spine board down, Dolly.

Dolly: OK Zulu....hurry, he's hurt real bad...I'll put this splint on him. (Zulu is lowered down) (Doc and Singh can be seen helping Mallory). Should see your car Doc, its a mess.

Doc: (Leaning over the edge) I don't want to look. I might become emotional like my daughter.

Mallory: Besco said you wouldn't come near us if we got hurt.

Curley: We all need each other sometimes, son.

(Zulu and Dolly strap Besco onto the spine board).

Dolly: I hope these ropes hold out Zulu, I don't want to end up down there with Doc's car.

Zulu: Right on.

Jane: (holding walkie-talkie) Alpha - Bravo - Zero 7 calling Zero Zero 825 over....10-4... over

Curley: (to Mallory) See how these people (indicating Rescue Squad) even though they're a different race from you and Besco and me...they work together, risking their lives for us. (Zulu and Dolly keep working on Besco for a while).

Mallory: I never thought of it like that...we're all different but yet...the same.

Curley: We're all humans aren't we...?

Mallory: Besco doesn't like some nationalities...I think it's something to do with his father getting killed in Vietnam (or whatever was established by Connie in Scene 4.)

Curley: That's understandable. How about you son?

Mallory: Oh! I don't know. I just go along with Besco.

Singh: Goodness me! Look where that got you - almost killed!

Mallory: Yeh! I'll say.

Curley: Him up there (indicating God) He doesn't judge people by their nationality son...so neither should we...look at that (indicating downward) Black and white working together to save a prejudiced boy who hates them!

Mallory: Yeh! I suppose.

Dolly: Are you ready Curley? (Shouted)

(They raise Besco on the spine board - Doc works on him)

Curley: Notify the hospital, Constable. Let 'em know we're coming.

Jane: 10-4 Curley. (she again talks into walkie talkie behind following conversation)

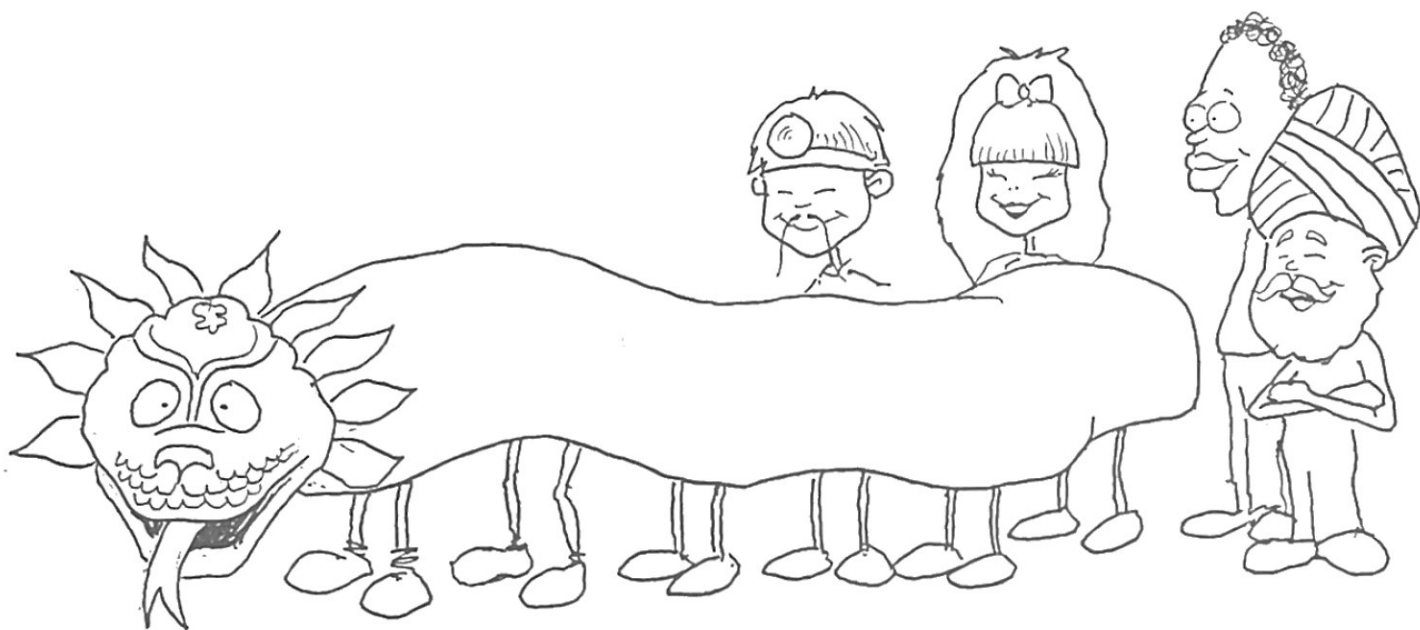
Singh: Careful now (as they lift Besco over edge of cliff) Goodness gracious....it's that Besco boy....I met his mother the other day!

Curley: OK everyone, lets get them over to the hospital...then we'll go back to the concert.

CURTAINS – as Besco is carried away in a stretcher – siren sounds and fades.

CONCERT - CROWD SCENE

Curtains open as Chinese group are performing their act. Chinese dragon is "dancing" around circle in comical way. As music ends, Rescue Squad enters - crowd applauds - lots of talking and back-patting.



Tangles: (as applause fades) What happened Mr Singh..? Are they all right..?

Mim: Did you rescue 'em?

Singh: Oh! Dearie me...what a sight it was.

Curley: But they're OK now! Doc's patching them up...at the hospital.

Mim: Whose car was it?

Jane: It was Dr Loo Chong's Jaguar...it's a write off.

Tan: (begins to cry) Ooh! Daddy only just bought it.

Sandra: Oh! No! Here she goes again. (comforting Tan) Never mind...Tan. It was insured.

Curley: Let's have some more dancing everyone. Jane and I will start it off. (music for Zorba the Greek begins). (They dance and others join in. Doc enters at end of Zorba, does a comical routine and lands flat on his back - all laugh and clap.)

Curley: Listen everyone, I asked Doc to try and bring Besco and his mother over here to the festival - as soon as Doc patches him up. They should be here soon. Let's make them feel welcome...we must not hold grudges now! (All applaud and agree).

Jane: Great work Curley!

Curley: In the meantime, how about you young Russians dance for us?

(Concert continues till ready. Then the song - "Melting Pot" is sung by Rescue Squad. Suggest Rescue Squad is standing around a large "melting pot" stirring as they sing, passing along in a chain imaginary "pieces" to drop in the melting pot).

(Enter Besco in wheelchair with Doc and Mrs Exide).

(All applaud as they enter...fade to complete silence).

Besco: (Long pause before he speaks ... with his head bowed) I don't know why I did it... (wipes tears away) (Mrs Exide takes tissue out of purse, dries her tears)...(pause) I wish Dad would come back from (East Timor)...(more tear wiping).

Mrs Exide: (with tears) He's not coming back son...he's....he's....missing (she puts her arm around him). The other house wives gather around to comfort her.)

Curley: Can we have your medley of songs again girls? We'll all join in this time. Everybody ready?

("Mothers" begin their medley again – choir and stage audience join in – sway and join hands etc. Medley concludes with key change up to "Melting Pot" as cast begin their bows to audience).

CURTAINS

